

Mikhail Stepanov

Head of Backend

-  Worldwide
-  the.mikhail.stepanov@gmail.com
-  @go_on_maggot_brain

About

Backend engineer and engineering leader with 9 years of experience. I design solution architectures and build distributed, reliable, and fault-tolerant services on the JVM stack and beyond. I manage development, IT strategy, and teams and beyond.

Languages

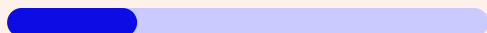
English



Russian



Deutsch



Hard Skills

- Solution Architecture
- System Design, DDD
- Java / Kotlin / Python
- Postgres, Redis, S3, Clickhouse
- AWS, Heroku, Cloud.ru, KServe
- Kafka, Kinesis, RabbitMQ

Education

2022 - 2025 | Systems Analysis

PhD, HSE University

2020 - 2022 | Business Informatics

MsC, HSE University

2019 - 2020 | Cyber Security

Exchange, BTU, Germany

2016 - 2020 | Computer Science

BsC, HSE University

Soft Skills

- Empathy!
- IT strategy development
- Team management and growth
- Release and SDLC management
- Conflict management
- Decision-making and trade-off analysis
- Cross-functional collaboration
- Operational management

Experience

Head of Backend

SberEducation | Full Time | 2025 - now

- Lead the backend organization: hiring, engineer development, shaping the team's organizational structure.
 - Design system architecture and evolve internal platform solutions.
 - Define the technology stack and shape the technical strategy for the unit.
 - Introduce and promote engineering best practices across the team.
 - Own code quality, stability, and performance of services.
 - Work closely with the CTO, heads of adjacent units, and stakeholders.
 - Amid turbulence, the team shipped a new product in just 3 months - a record pace for a heavily regulated corporation.
 - Maintained and increased team motivation despite layoffs, periodic shifts in product focus, and an uncertain future
-

Founding Engineer

Oneum.io | co-founder | 2024 - 2025

Designed the solution and architecture. Built the system model, hired the team, and developed a chatbot powered by OpenAI models with integrations into messengers and CRM systems.

Tech Lead

Align Technology Inc. | Full Time | 2023 - 2025

Sr. Software Engineer

2020 - 2023

Designed and developed backend for the orthodontist portal:

- Redesigned the scan service architecture, reducing search latency from 20 seconds to 150 ms.
 - Reduced Kafka event processing latency between US and China clusters from 800 ms to 200 ms via batch processing.
 - Introduced a contract-first approach between backend and frontend, cutting integration bugs and accelerating parallel development.
 - Designed solution architectures driven by business needs and available resources, balancing delivery speed with long-term maintainability.
 - Improved cross-functional team processes: automated code-analysis pipelines, test-generation practices using AWS Bedrock, sprint and release-cycle reviews.
 - Hired and onboarded new engineers, ran 1-on-1s, set quarterly team goals.
-

Lecturer

GeekBrains | Contractor | 2020 - 2021

Conducted lectures on system architecture, Java, and Spring Framework.

Java Developer

Business Environment LLC | Full Time | 2019 - 2020

Developed backend for an entrepreneur education platform.

Junior Java Developer

E-COM | Full Time | 2019 - 2019

Developed backend for a document management system in the retail sector.

Performance Test Engineer

Aplana Software | Full Time | 2017 - 2019

Load testing for VTB Bank projects: LoadRunner, JMeter, stubs, test cases.
